

1. Usage

Adobe Animate is more traditional animation software. It is used for the creation of most of the animation – like the cartoons you might see on the television or the web. It has all the traditional tools required for animation with very limited content awareness. Particularly when it comes to new and freelance animators, Adobe Animator continues to be the first choice due to its easy accessibility and intuitive user interface. It carries the legacy of Adobe Flash, and thousands of animators are acquainted with its tools and ways of usage. For years, it carried a vast majority of the market share when it came to animation software, especially for two-dimensional animation. In comparison, Adobe Character Animator is a rather infantile software, having come into being as a plugin in 2015 when it came pre-installed in Adobe After Effects. Adobe Character Animator is used for very specific types of animation, and most where motion capture is also involved. The best feature of Adobe Character Animator is the fact that it contains a vast amount of content awareness, which saves animators time and hard labour.

2. Time

In Adobe Animate, animation needs to be done the traditional way — all the scenes need to be thought out and decided beforehand, a screenplay is to be made (if required), scene durations have to be determined, and then the process of animation is started. Admittedly, this can take a lot of time as well as a monetary investment. A vast majority of the animation is still done in these ways since there is much greater customizability and the animator gets to decide what comes on screen. Adobe Character Animator uses a significantly lower time for animation, mainly due to the fact that it can capture real-time motion as well as voice. Animations that have a very short turnover time and need to be produced on the go, benefit immensely from this. Animation on this can be created practically live at the time of publication.

3. Activity

The amount of activity that your content can have varies vastly in Adobe Animate and Adobe Character Animator. As a standalone software, Adobe Character Animator is developed to capture complex activities by humans in real-time with the use of motion capture technology, which is then converted into live animated footage. While this capability is under development and likely to be enhanced over the next few years, and is not commercially